

BIG WIN
Elyria Catholic runs out to big lead, coasts to victory against Lorain Catholic.
B5



COLLEGE BASKETBALL
Midview grad Anthony Stacey set to make history tonight
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INDIANS
Ownership officially passed to Larry Dolan
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HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL
Southview, Lutheran West, Open Door among winners
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Sports

The Chronicle-Telegram Wednesday, February 16, 2000 **B1**



Dan Coughlin

Tiger's streak versus Byron's: No comparison

I took up golf briefly in the late 1950s and I could have been decent, not the laughing stock I turned into.

Several times one spring I played the Notre Dame golf course with Father "Eighty-Eight" Brennan, a logic professor who never gave a grade lower than 88.

For some odd reason, all the Notre Dame football players wound up in his class. The luck of the draw, I guess. Father Brennan was an old priest by then and he had supreme confidence in his teaching ability.

"If you come to all my classes and just sit there and listen, you will learn logic," he claimed.

At the end of each semester, he would throw the final tests into the air and declares, "The ones that stick to the ceiling flunk." Everybody else got an 88.

I never sat in Father Brennan's class, but playing golf with him was the next best thing. He was short off the tee, but every shot was right down the middle.

"What did you get, Father?" I would ask after each round. "It looks like an 88," he would say.

"Another 88," I would marvel.

He did not use the stubby pencils they give you at the pro shop. His pencil had an eraser on the end.

I hardly played again. It was expensive and time-consuming. Golf was a luxury and I came from a working-class family. I always remembered my mother counting out the money — to the penny — to pay Ed Havens, the insurance man, who came once a month.

You may draw the logical conclusion that I am not an avid follower of professional golf. I may watch the final round of the Masters or the U.S. Open because that is sporting history.

But Sunday I was glued to the set for the final holes as Tiger Woods tried to win a seventh-straight tournament. Tiger has turned every Sunday into Super Bowl Sunday on the PGA Tour.

Tiger finished second and his streak of tournament victories was snapped at six, of course, barely halfway to Byron Nelson's all-time record of 11 in a row set in 1945.

The comparisons are the proverbial apples and oranges. All apples are fruit. Not all fruit are apples. It is impossible to compare Tiger's six in a row today with Nelson's 11 straight 55 years ago. It is like comparing pitcher Jack Chesbro's 41 victories for the 1904 Yankees with a 20-win season today.

The games have changed. It was a different world in 1945 when Lord Byron rampaged through the pro golf tour like Patton charged across Europe.

World War II changed everything. Sometimes you couldn't get enough men together for a church league softball game, much less a golf tournament.

The pro golf tour was still a fledgling circuit in the 1940s and it was drastically curtailed during the war. In 1945 there was no

See COUGHLIN, B5

Welcome back

Murray gets 27 points as Cavs return from All-Star break with upset of Spurs

NEXT UP

WHO: Nuggets at Cavs
WHEN: 7:30 p.m. Thursday
WHERE: Gund Arena
TV/RADIO: Fox Sports Ohio; WTAM 1100-AM; WEOL 930-AM

Rick Noland
The Chronicle-Telegram

CLEVELAND — The San Antonio Spurs should have offered Lamond Murray a couple more bucks.

About to sign with the defending NBA champions until a last-minute, sign-and-trade deal sent him from the Los Angeles Clippers to the Cavs on Aug. 4, Murray had game-highs of 27 points and 12 rebounds as Cleveland beat the Spurs 92-81 Tuesday night at Gund Arena.

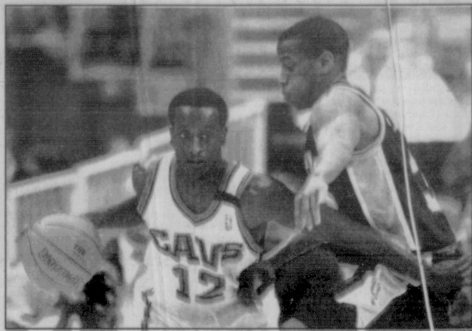
"You never know how things would have went," said Murray, who signed a seven-year, \$29

million contract before the Clips dealt him to the Cavs for Derek Anderson and Johnny Newman. "It was a last-minute situation that came about. I had to do what was best for me and my family."

In the first game after the All-Star break, the 6-foot-7 forward did what was best for the Cavs (20-30), making 10-of-21 shots in 39 active minutes. The Spurs (32-18), meanwhile, got six points from their starting small forward, Jerome Kersey.

"(Murray) got off to a shaky start offensively," Cleveland

See CAVS, B4



KNIGHT RIDER: Cavaliers forward Brevin Knight moves the ball around Spurs guard Antonio Daniels in the second quarter Tuesday at Gund Arena in Cleveland.



LINDA MURPHY/CHRONICLE

UP FOR TWO: Olmsted Falls' Mike Gansey (32) shoots past Avon Lake's Paul Skellinger (left) and Falls' Greg Koch Tuesday night at Olmsted Falls.

Falls takes SWC

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED FALLS — The Southwestern Conference championship was won the way it is drawn up on the chalkboard of the mind — on the champs' home court, against the only other team with a chance to wear the crown.

That was how Olmsted Falls took its fifth straight SWC title. The Bulldogs defeated second-place Avon Lake, 68-58, to run their conference record to 12-1 and their overall mark to 16-2. Their victory also avenged the only loss the Dogs had suffered in the circuit, a 61-52 verdict Jan. 11 at Avon Lake.

Bulldogs claim title with win over Shoremen

But it wasn't easy. Falls was ahead by only a point with less than four minutes remaining. Avon Lake (13-4, 9-4 SWC) owned the lead at halftime and was never behind by more than six points until a six-point burst by the Bulldogs between 3:23 and 2:08 to play. The final margin represented Olmsted Falls' largest lead.

"We felt pretty good at halftime, after all the adversity of the first half," Falls coach Pat

Donahue said.

Two of Donahue's starters, guards Gary Reitter and Manzie Williams, picked up two fouls each very quickly in the first quarter. The coach sat them down and didn't re-insert them for the rest of the first half. But the Shoremen, despite having two of the opponent's regulars on the bench, could only manage a two-point edge at the break.

"The guy who really carried us through that was Mike Gansey," Donahue said. "He put the team on his back and wasn't going to let us get too far behind."

See FALLS, B4

Buckeyes not up to MSU challenge

Penn scores 30, but gets no help as Spartans roll

Ralph Paalk
Knight Ridder Newspapers

EAST LANSING, Mich. — Ohio State guard Scoonie Penn stood toe-to-toe with his Big Ten rival, Michigan State guard Mateen Cleaves.

His teammates, however, were kicked around by the Spartans. And, with 14:40 left to play, Ohio State coach Jim O'Brien was kicked out of the arena after drawing his second technical foul.

Penn scored a season-high 30 points, but his effort wasn't nearly enough, as Michigan State won 83-72 before a crowd of 14,569 at Breslin Center.

Cleaves had 24 points and seven assists, but, unlike Penn, he had plenty of help. Morris Peterson (26) and Charlie Bell (23) combined for 49 points.

The victory gave the No. 6

Spartans (19-6, 9-2) sole possession of first place in the Big Ten and avenged an 11-point loss to Ohio State (17-5, 8-3) last month. Now, No. 7 Ohio State travels to Bloomington, Ind., on Saturday to play No. 10 Indiana.

The Buckeyes staggered out of the gate to begin a make-or-break week of conference play. They negated a 4-of-5 shooting performance by committing five turnovers in the first three minutes.

"We couldn't afford to get off to a slow start," said O'Brien, who was ejected for only the second time in his 18 years as a head coach. "We were careless; then we dug ourselves too deep in the hole."

O'Brien was visibly frustrated, as the Buckeyes struggled to find an open shot in their half-court sets. When the Buckeyes couldn't draw a foul as they drove to the basket, O'Brien lost it.

He was whistled for a technical with 10:50 left in the first half. Peterson hit both free throws to give Michigan State a 20-13 lead.

See BUCKEYES, B4

SECTIONAL HOCKEY

Panthers' solid season comes crashing down

Rocky River knocks out EC, 6-3

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

BROOKLYN — It took Elyria Catholic's hockey team five years to put together its finest season. It came apart in less than two minutes Tuesday night.

In a second-period barrage, Rocky River scored three goals in 1:59 to shatter a 1-1 tie in a sectional tournament opener at Brooklyn Recreation Center.

The final score was 6-3, Pirates, but the game wasn't really that close despite a frenetic third-period comeback by the Panthers.

Elyria Catholic's season ends at 20-6-1. Rocky River, 11-14, advances to play Euclid on Saturday. Euclid waxed Benedictine 9-1

in Tuesday's first game.

"I thought we played pretty well with them the first period," said EC coach Dave Phiel. "We had our chances and popped the power-play goal in. The second period we had some great chances early. B.J. (Basinger) had a couple breakaways and he pops one of those in and the momentum changes."

"But they came down and got a couple soft ones," Phiel said. "There was that short period when the got three goals and that really just kind of shut us down."

The Panthers trailed 1-0 when River's R.J. Christyson went off for cross-checking at 3:33. This

See PANTHERS, B4

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